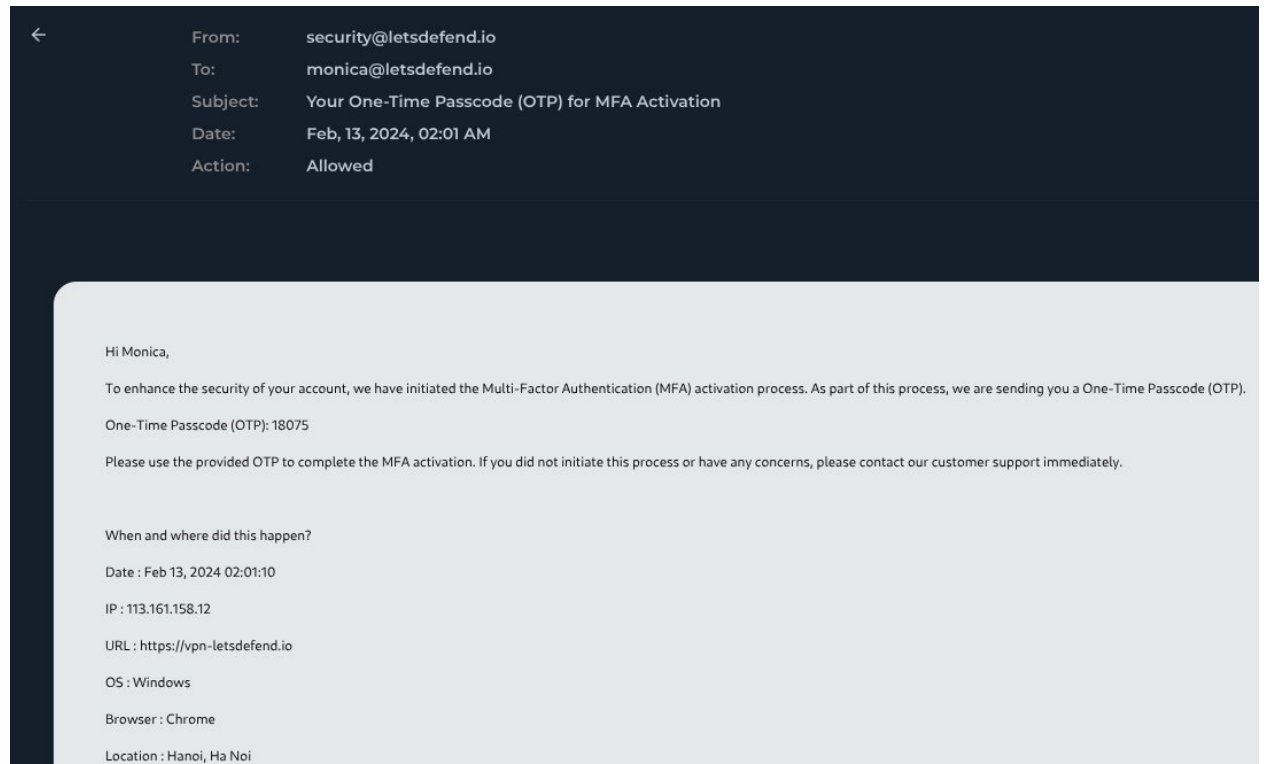


Event Information:

EventID :
225
Event Time :
Feb, 13, 2024, 02:04 AM
Rule :
SOC257 - VPN Connection Detected from Unauthorized Country
Level :
Security Analyst
Source Address :
113.161.158.12
Destination Address :
33.33.33.33
Destination Hostname :
Monica
Username :
monica@letsdefend.io
Alert Trigger Reason :
Vpn Connection Detected from Unauthorized Country
URL :
https://vpn-letsdefend.io

Analysis Steps:

After checking email logs to the recipient in the relevant time-frame 3 2fa request emails were found with the device location for all coming from Vietnam.



Logs were searched with the IP 113[.]161.158.12 as the source yielding 21 events.

21 events (before Feb, 13, 2024, 02:03 AM UTC)

< 1 2 3 >

< Hide Fields

INTERESTING FIELDS

α type

α source_address

source_port

α destination_address

destination_port

α raw_log

Event

[Feb, 13, 2024, 01:54 AM] source_address=113.161.158.12 source_port=33309 destination_address=33.33.33.33 destination_port=55997 raw_log: {}

Field	Value
type	Firewall
source_address	113.161.158.12
source_port	33309
destination_address	33.33.33.33
destination_port	55997
time	Feb, 13, 2024, 01:54 AM

[Feb, 13, 2024, 01:56 AM] source_address=113.161.158.12 source_port=61654 destination_address=33.33.33.33 destination_port=48090 raw_log: {}

The attacker can be observed scanning various ports and conducting reconnaissance activities on the network. They eventually begin specifically targeting the LetsDefend VPN.

21 events (before Feb, 13, 2024, 02:03 AM UTC)

< 1 2 3 >

< Hide Fields

INTERESTING FIELDS

α type

α source_address

source_port

α destination_address

destination_port

α raw_log

Event

RAW DATA

Date=13/Feb/2024:02:01:01 +0000, URL=https://vpn-letsdefend.io, Source IP=113.161.158.12, Request=POST, URI=/login.html, Protocol=HTTP/1.0, Response Status=200, Username=Monica@letsdefend.io

destination_address	33.33.33.33
destination_port	443
time	Feb, 13, 2024, 02:01 AM
Raw Log	
Raw Data	Date=13/Feb/2024:02:01:01 +0000, URL=https://vpn-letsdefend.io, So...

[Feb, 13, 2024, 02:03 AM] source_address=113.161.158.12 source_port=36078 destination_address=33.33.33.33 destination_port=443 raw_log: {"Raw ...

The attacker receives a 200 response and this may indicate that Monica's password has been discovered but as can be observed by email and network logs 2fa is protecting their account.

21 events (before Feb, 13, 2024, 02:03 AM UTC)

< 1 2 3 >

< Hide Fields

INTERESTING FIELDS

α type

α source_address

source_port

α destination_address

destination_port

α raw_log

Event

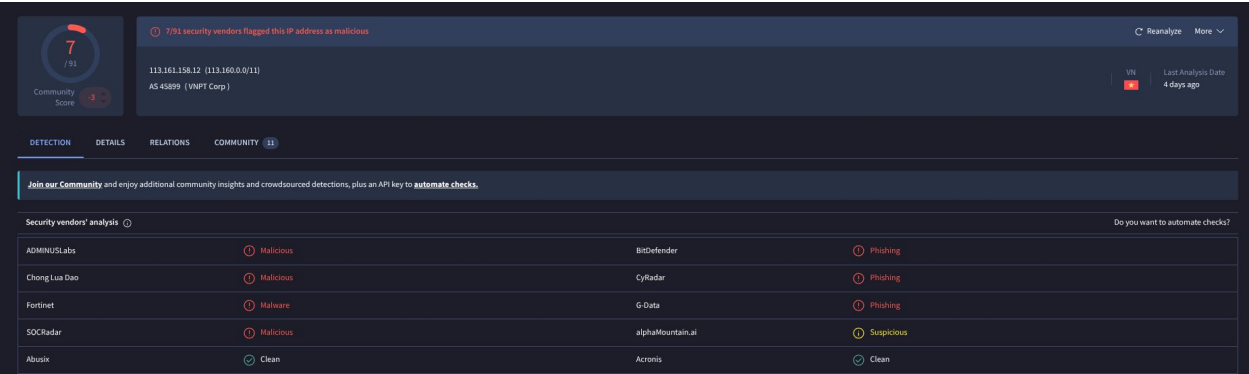
source_address	113.161.158.12
source_port	36078
destination_address	33.33.33.33
destination_port	443
time	Feb, 13, 2024, 02:03 AM
Raw Log	
Date	02-13-2023, 02:03 AM
Source	113.161.158.12
Dest	vpn-letsdefend.io
User	monica@letsdefend.io
Action	Incorrect OTP Code

It can also be observed that Monica's device has not been accessed since before the attack started.

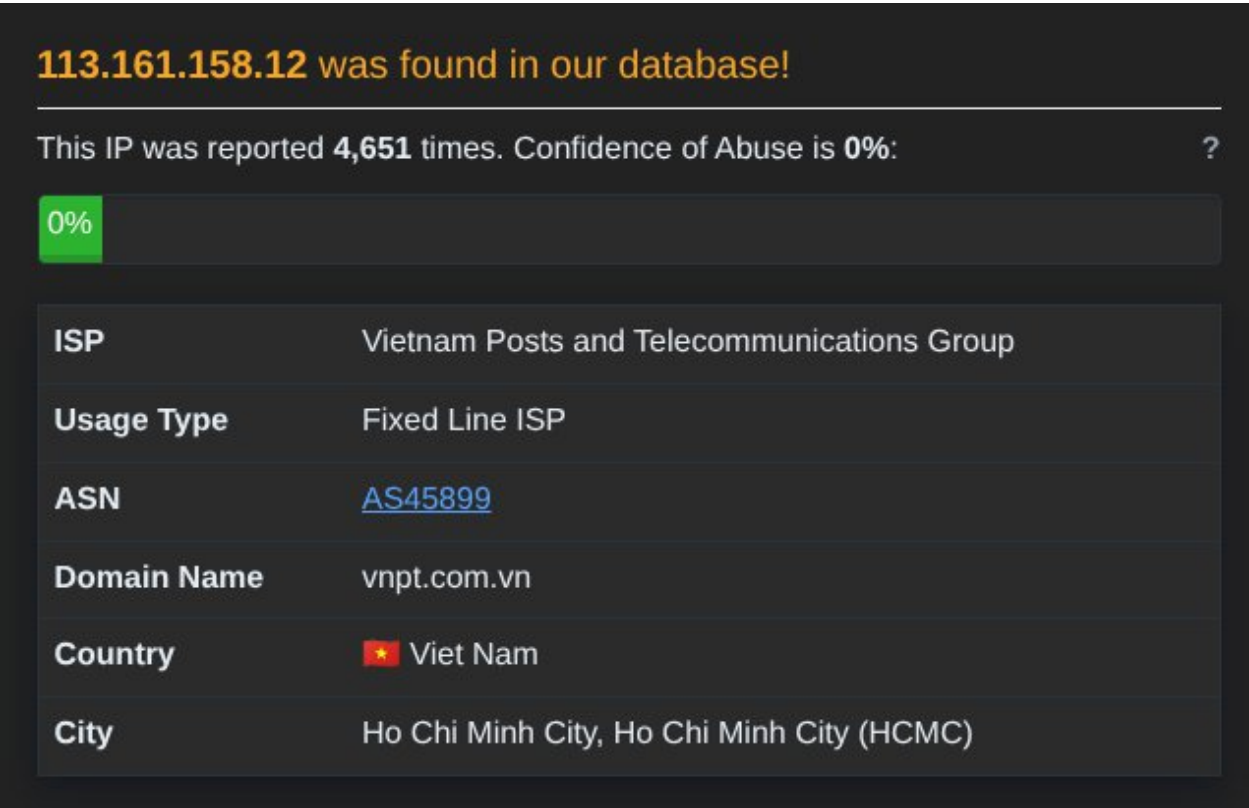
Host Information	
Hostname:	Monica
Domain:	LetsDefend
IP Address:	172.16.17.163
Bit Level:	64
OS:	Windows 10
Primary User:	Monica
Client/Server:	Client
Last Login:	<u>Feb, 12, 2024, 04:41 PM</u>

This information was enough to conclude that the alert was a failed True Positive.

The offending IP is not in our CTI database and is external to the organisation. No emails have been received indicating penetration testing involving the IP for the relevant time period. VirusTotal indicates it is a Vietnamese address associated with 113.161.158.12 AS 45899 (VNPT Corp). 7/91 security vendors flagged this IP address as malicious as of 4 days ago.



On AbuseIPDB this IP was reported 4,651 times with a 0% confidence of abuse. User reports seems to evidence this IP has been involved with various brute forcing (especially SSH) activities.



Based on following Playbook procedure and the analysis of available information, this alert is determined to be a failed True Positive.

Report:

Incident Summary

Analysis confirms a True Positive failed VPN compromise attempt targeting an internal user. An external threat actor operating from Vietnam successfully compromised the user's password, but the intrusion was halted by the Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) system.

Incident Details

- **Alert Name:** SOC257 - VPN Connection Detected from Unauthorized Country
- **Target Account:** monica[.]letsdefend[.]io
- **Target VPN Portal:** hxxps://vpn-letsdefend[.]io (33[.]33.33.33)
- **Attacker IP:** 113[.]161.158.12

Analysis and Evidence

- **Network Reconnaissance:** Firewall logs indicate the attacker IP (113[.]161.158.12) conducted port scanning and reconnaissance activities prior to explicitly targeting the VPN infrastructure.
- **Credential Compromise:** Network telemetry shows a successful POST request to logon.html resulting in a 200 OK status. Email logs confirm this action triggered three separate One-Time Passcode (OTP) emails to the user, proving the attacker possessed the correct username and password.
- **MFA Prevention:** VPN logs record the action "Incorrect OTP Code" originating from the attacker's IP. This confirms the threat actor was unable to bypass the secondary authentication requirement to establish a VPN tunnel.
- **Endpoint Verification:** Host logs confirm the target's machine (Monica / 172[.]16.17.163) was last accessed on Feb 12, 2024, at 04:41 PM, well before the attack occurred, verifying no successful session was established.

Threat Intelligence

- **OSINT (Infrastructure):** The offending IP (113[.]161.158.12) is external to the organisation and maps to VNPT Corp (AS 45899) in Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam.
- **Reputation:** VirusTotal indicates 7/91 security vendors flag this IP address as malicious. AbuseIPDB lists 4,651 reports for the IP, with user comments frequently associating it with brute-forcing activities.

Actions Taken

1. Analysed network and VPN logs, confirming the threat actor performed reconnaissance before attempting to authenticate.
2. Correlated VPN requests with email logs, confirming the attacker compromised the primary password but failed the OTP challenge.
3. Verified endpoint login history to ensure no unauthorised sessions were active.
4. Declared the alert as a failed True Positive.

Recommendation:

Mandate an immediate password reset for monica[.]letsdefend[.]io and to block the offending IP (113[.]161.158.12) at the perimeter firewall.

Let's Defend Result

SOC257 - VPN Connection Detected from Unauthorized Country

True Positive (+5 Point)

Does the device need to be isolated? (+5 Point)

Is sensitive data at risk? (+5 Point)

Has a critical system been affected? (+5 Point)

Check IP Reputation (+5 Point)

Does the IP address belong to the internal network or external network? (+5 Point)

Define threat actor (+5 Point)

Determine whether alert was TP or FP (+5 Point)